

Individual Class Activity: Designing a Mini Research Study

Course: AF3008 - Business Research & Data Mining

Instructor: Dr. Usama Arshad

Duration: 20-25 minutes

Activity Type: Individual

Objective

Students will individually define a research problem, choose an appropriate research method, write a short methodology, and design a simple experiment or analysis plan.

Scenario

A FinTech startup called QuickPay has launched a mobile payment application for small businesses. After six months, the company observed that many users stop using the app after the first few weeks.

The management wants to conduct a research study to understand the reasons behind low user retention and identify ways to improve long-term engagement.

You are hired as a business research analyst to design the research study.

Instructions

Answer the following questions individually and briefly.

1. Research Problem

Write a clear research problem statement.

2. Research Method

Choose the most appropriate research method and justify your choice.

Examples: Survey research, Observational data analysis, Experiment (A/B testing), Mixed method.

3. Data Sources

List three possible data sources that could help analyze the problem.

Examples: App usage logs, transaction history, customer surveys, customer feedback.

4. Methodology

Write 3–4 steps, headings describing how the research will be conducted.

Example: Collect user data → Conduct survey → Analyze patterns → Interpret results.

5. Experiment or Analysis

Propose one experiment or analytical approach.

Example: A/B testing of two app interfaces or regression analysis to study factors affecting retention.

6. Evaluation Metrics

Suggest two metrics to evaluate the results.

Examples: Customer retention rate, daily active users, number of transactions per user.

Submission

Write your answers on paper or submit digitally as instructed by the instructor.